BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #69 · HEALING AND FAITH

“Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious.”

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Where it often comes from

Many churches speak of joy and peace without space for struggle. Believers who feel depressed or anxious may think they are failing, or that they are not truly saved.

What Scripture teaches

David wrote, “Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God.” Elijah wanted to die, and God cared for him. Jesus was “a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief,” and in Gethsemane He said, “My soul is consumed with sorrow to the point of death” (Matthew 26:38). Paul wrote of being “hard pressed on all sides.” Depression and anxiety can have many causes, including biology, loss, stress, and trauma. They are not signs of unbelief, and help is available.

> *“Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God”* (Psalm 42:11).

Also see

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” (Isaiah 53:3).

> “Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’” (1 Kings 19:5).

> “When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul” (Psalm 94:19).

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

Common self-statements

- Real Christians are always joyful.
- I am failing God.
- I should be able to pray this away.
- My faith must be weak.
- I should not need help.
- Others will think less of me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a Christian is either joyful or faithless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling low and concluding my faith is false.
- Labeling: Calling myself a bad Christian.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that Christians do not feel this way?

- Which biblical figures struggled with sadness or fear?
- What does my body and life situation contribute?
- What help have I sought: doctor, counselor, friends, pastor?
- What does Scripture say about God's nearness to the downcast?
- What is one next step?

Truth summary

> Depression and anxiety are not failures of faith. Many faithful people have struggled. God is near, and help through counseling, medical care, and community is part of His provision.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Suffering
- Therapy
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that Christians do not feel this way?
- ☐ Which biblical figures struggled with sadness or fear?
- ☐ What does my body and life situation contribute?
- ☐ What help have I sought: doctor, counselor, friends, pastor?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's nearness to the downcast?
- ☐ What is one next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ David was downcast, too.
- ☐ Jesus knew sorrow.
- ☐ God cares for the weary.
- ☐ Struggle is not unbelief.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 42:11**
  "Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God."
- ☐ **Isaiah 53:3**
  "He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not."
- ☐ **1 Kings 19:5**
  "Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Help and hope: Each week, note one step of care and one truth.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 42:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "David was downcast, and God was near to him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Depression, Symptoms of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Tell someone. Share with a trusted person.
- [ ] See a professional. Doctor or Christian counselor.
- [ ] Read Psalm 42. Pray it as your own.
- [ ] If thoughts of self-harm come, call or text 988 (U.S.). Call 911 in an emergency.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Help and hope
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am weighed down. Meet me in my sadness and fear, send help, and let me know You are near. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.